



Chromosome One of 46 threadlike packages of DNA found in the nucleus of body cells.

Computed Tomography (CT) scanning An imaging technique that uses X-rays to produce 2-D and 3-D images of body organs.

Conception The time between fertilization of an egg cell by a sperm and settling of an embryo in the lining of the womb.

Dendrite A short fiber that extends from a nerve cell (neuron). It carries incoming electrical signals from other nerve cells.

Deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) A long molecule found inside the nucleus of body cells. DNA contains coded instructions that control how cells work and how your body grows and develops.

Digestion The process that breaks down food into tiny particles that your body can absorb and use.

Digestive enzyme A substance that speeds up the breakdown of food molecules.

Disease Any problem with the body that may make a person feel unwell. Diseases caused by germs are called infectious diseases. Many are spread from person to person, for example by coughs or sneezes.

Dopamine A chemical released in your brain when you feel excitement or pleasure. Dopamine is a type of neurotransmitter—it travels across the tiny gap between neighboring nerve cells to pass a signal on.

Embryo The name given to a developing baby between the time it arrives in the womb and eight weeks after fertilization.

Emotions Inner feelings that are produced by the brain, including joy, fear, and anger.

Endocrine gland A type of gland, such as the pituitary gland, that releases hormones into your bloodstream.

Enzyme A substance that speeds up a particular chemical reaction in the body.

Epiglottis A flap of tissue that closes your trachea when you swallow food to stop the food from entering.

Feces Another name for poo. The solid waste made up of undigested food, dead cells, and bacteria that is left over after digestion and expelled from your anus.

Fat A substance found in many foods that provides energy and important ingredients for cells. The layer of cells just under the skin is full of fat.

Fertilization The joining together of a female egg (ovum) and male sperm to make a new individual.

Fetus The name given to a developing baby from the ninth week after fertilization until it is born.

Fever A rise in body temperature above the normal range.

Genes Instructions that control the way your body develops and works. Genes are passed on from parents to their children.

Genome The DNA contained in a set of chromosomes. In humans, there are 46 chromosomes.

Germ A tiny living thing that can get into your body and make you sick. Bacteria and viruses are types of germs.

Gland A group of specialized cells that make and release a particular substance, such as an enzyme or a hormone.

Glucose A simple type of sugar that circulates in the bloodstream and is the main energy source for the body's cells.

Gravity The force that pulls objects toward the ground.

Gray matter Brain tissue that consists largely of the cell bodies of neurons. The outer layer of the brain is gray matter.

Hippocampus A part of the brain that helps store long-term memories.

Hormone A chemical produced by glands in order to change the way a different part of the body works. Hormones are carried by the blood.

Hypothalamus A small structure in the base of your brain that controls many body activities, including temperature and thirst.

Immune system A collection of cells and tissues that protect the body from disease by searching out and destroying germs and cancer cells.

Infection If germs invade your body and begin to multiply, they cause an infection. Some diseases are caused by infections.

▼ **MESSAGE CENTER** *Your brain is your body's communication hub. Signals are received from and sent to your body through your nerves.*

